

The Tiger's Whisker

An old **hermit** lived in the Lun Mountains of Korea. Many people **sought** his advice, for he was a **font** of **wisdom** and was knowledgeable in the magical arts. One day, a woman came and **pleaded** with him to help her regain her husband's **affection**.

"He was so loving and caring before he left for the wars," she explained. "He has returned after three years, but now he is **cold** and **aloof**."

"War does these things to men," said the hermit.

"They say you can make a **potion** that can **kindle** love in the person who consumes it," said the woman.

"I could make such a potion, it is true, but I **lack** one of the ingredients that go into its making."

"What is this ingredient?" asked the woman.

"It is a tiger's **whisker**."

The woman left, promising to get what he wanted. The very next day, she went in search of a tiger and finally saw one on the **banks** of a river. The tiger **snarled** when he saw her and she **retreated**.

She returned to the spot the next day. Again, the tiger snarled, and again she retreated. But she kept going to the place, and **gradually** the animal got used to her presence and stopped snarling.

She began to bring him food. **In course of time**, the tiger became so friendly that he would come right up to her to take the food.

One day she **timidly reached out** and **patted** his head.

A few days later, she ran her hand down the side of his face.

And then one day, she **deftly** pulled out one of his whiskers.



She **rushed** to the hermit's house with the whisker.

"I've got it!" she said **triumphantly**.

"Good," said the hermit.

He took the whisker to the fireplace and dropped it into the fire.

"W-what have you done!" said the woman, **aghast**. "You promised to make me a magic potion!"

"You don't need one," said the hermit, softly.

"Tell me, how did you win the tiger's affection? Through **gentleness** and **a great deal of patience**.

Would a man be less responsive than a **savage** and **bloodthirsty beast**? Go and win over your husband as you did the tiger."

The woman **turned over** what the hermit had said in her mind as she slowly made her way home.

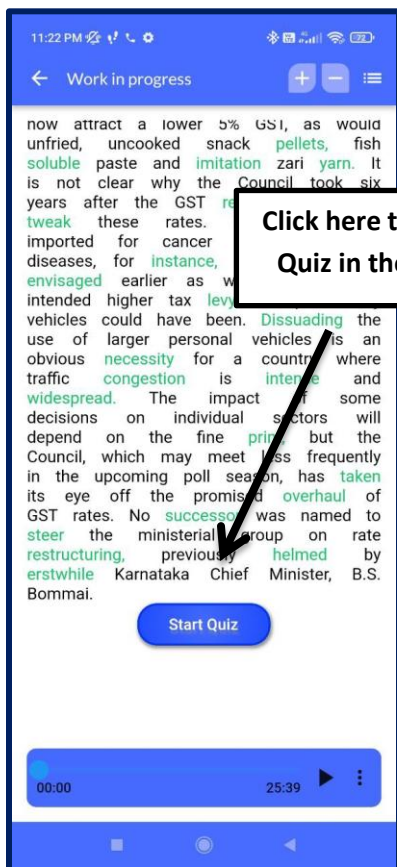
When she saw her husband, her first **instinct** was to **turn away**. Then remembering the tiger and the hermit's words, she checked herself and moved forward, a smile on her face.

Vocabulary

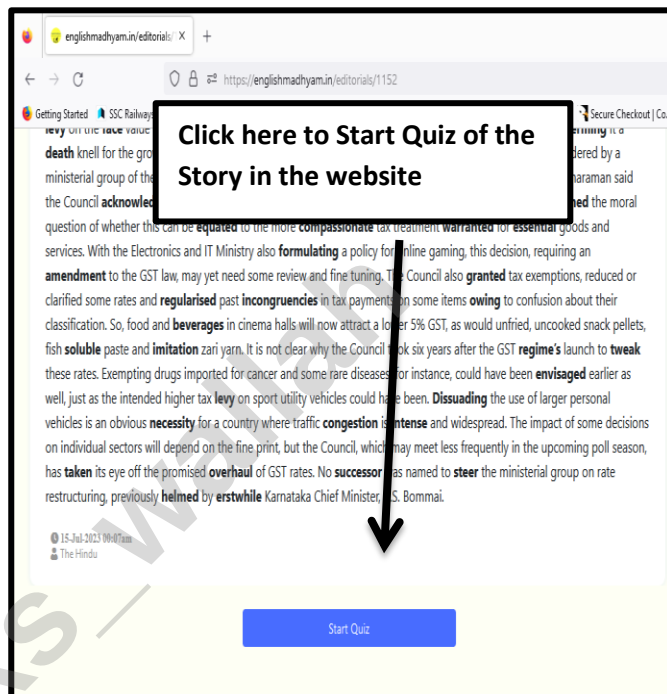
1. **Hermit** (noun) – Recluse, ascetic, monk, solitary, anchorite सन्यासी
2. **Seek** (verb) – Search for, look for, pursue, request, strive for खोजना
3. **Font** (noun) – Source, spring, reservoir, wellspring, origin स्रोत / भंडार
4. **Wisdom** (noun) – Knowledge, insight, prudence, sagacity, understanding बुद्धिमत्ता
5. **Plead** (verb) – Beg, implore, appeal, entreat, request विनती करना
6. **Affection** (noun) – Love, fondness, warmth, tenderness, devotion स्नेह
7. **Cold** (adjective) – Unfriendly, distant, indifferent, unresponsive, detached उदासीन
8. **Aloof** (adjective) – Detached, distant, reserved, withdrawn, indifferent अलग-थलग
9. **Potion** (noun) – Elixir, brew, concoction, mixture, tonic दवा
10. **Kindle** (verb) – Ignite, spark, arouse, stimulate, inspire जगाना
11. **Lack** (verb) – Be without, miss, need, want, require कमी होना
12. **Whisker** (noun) – Facial hair, bristle, mustache hair, stubble, vibrissa बिल्ली या जानवर की मूँछ का बाल
13. **Bank** (noun) – River edge, riverside, embankment, shore, waterfront किनारा
14. **Snarl** (verb) – Growl, roar, snap, bark, grumble गुराँना
15. **Retreat** (verb) – Withdraw, pull back, fall back, recede, back off वापिस जाना
16. **Gradually** (adverb) – Slowly, progressively, steadily, little by little, step by step धीरे-धीरे
17. **In course of time** (phrase) – Eventually, over time, gradually, in the long run, after a while समय के साथ
18. **Timidly** (adverb) – Shyly, hesitantly, nervously, fearfully, bashfully डरते हुए
19. **Reach out** (phrasal verb) – Extend, stretch out, offer, approach, make contact संपर्क करना
20. **Pat** (verb) – Tap, touch, stroke, caress, lightly slap हल्की थपकी देना
21. **Deftly** (adverb) – Skillfully, adroitly, cleverly, nimbly, expertly फुर्ती से
22. **Rush** (verb) – Hurry, dash, race, speed, bolt भागना

23. **Triumphantly** (adverb) – Victoriously, proudly, jubilantly, exultantly, successfully
विजयी भाव से / गर्व से
24. **Aghast** (adjective) – Shocked, horrified, stunned, appalled, astonished हक्का-बक्का
25. **Gentleness** (noun) – Kindness, softness, tenderness, mildness, compassion कोमलता
26. **A great deal of** (phrase) – A lot of, plenty of, considerable, abundant, substantial
बहुत सारा
27. **Patience** (noun) – Perseverance, tolerance, endurance, calmness, forbearance धैर्य
28. **Savage** (noun) – Wild one, brute, barbarian, beast, primitive क्रूर व्यक्ति
29. **Bloodthirsty** (adjective) – Violent, brutal, ruthless, ferocious, murderous हिंसक
30. **Beast** (noun) – Animal, creature, brute, monster, wild animal जानवर
31. **Turn over** (phrasal verb) – Think about, consider, ponder, reflect on, contemplate
विचार करना
32. **Instinct** (noun) – Impulse, intuition, gut feeling, natural tendency, reflex सहज ज्ञान
33. **Turn away** (phrasal verb) – Avoid, withdraw, avert, look aside, shun मुंह मोड़ लेना

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